

Project Olympus

Parent Guide and Setup, v.2026.9.10

What's in this build: the Workbench (the HTML app, now with cloud save), Unit 0 (1 week), Unit 1 (3 weeks), printable Teacher's Editions and practice sheets, Quest clue cards, badge art, and this guide. Read this once. It takes ten minutes. The cloud setup in Section 3 takes twenty more, once.

1. What this is

Project Olympus is a math program that runs in a web page, works on paper, and lives in your Math Program folder. Hudson does about 45 minutes, 3 to 4 times a week. Each session has a warm-up, a story (the idea, its history, every term defined), a practice set with instant feedback, an Apply block (Sheets, Desmos, an experiment, a trick), and a one-sentence log.

The math in Units 0 and 1: estimation and Fermi problems, then functions, graphs, slope, linear equations, and systems. That's the front half of Algebra I, plus the first sentence of physics (slope of a position graph is velocity). Everything is hung on things he cares about: the 2026 World Cup sprint speeds, Fortnite's actual storm timings, Minecraft's actual movement speeds, jiu-jitsu, card tricks, and the Greeks who invented half of it.

There is no grade. There is XP, which only goes up, and badges, some of which only you can award.

2. One-time setup (about 30 minutes, plus Section 3)

1. **Open the Workbench.** Two ways. Until the cloud setup is done: in the Math Program folder, open `Project Olympus v.2026.9.10` and double-click `Project Olympus.html` (opens in Chrome or Safari; open it from the folder on your Mac, not the Google Drive website). After Section 3: the web link, on any device.
 2. **Profiles.** The first screen asks who's climbing. Hudson and Dad each get one. With cloud save on, each profile has a 4-digit PIN (Section 3). Everyone starts as a Mortal.
 3. **Set the Dad PIN.** Click the "Dad mode" chip and set a 4-digit PIN (different from the profile PINs). Dad mode shows every answer key, hint, and solution; lets you award badges; shows Quest setups (hiding spots, lock combos); and unlocks printing. Turn it off before Hudson sits down. With cloud save on, the Dad PIN lives in the cloud too, so it works from any device.
 4. **Notebook.** One dedicated notebook. Page 1 is titled "The Codex" and the first 10 pages are reserved for it. Graph paper helps for Unit 1.
 5. **Calculator.** TI-30XS MultiView or similar (about \$20). Desmos (desmos.com/calculator, free) for graphing from Unit 1 Session 2 on.
 6. **Google Sheets.** He needs a Google account. He'll create one sheet, "Olympus Unit 0," and add tabs as he goes.
 7. **Colab (optional, 5 minutes).** colab.research.google.com, same Google account. Unit 0 Session 3 has him print 1024 in Python. Real Python starts in Unit 2.
 8. **Claude tutor.** Create a Claude Project (or a saved custom instruction) on your account for Hudson and paste in Appendix A. Test it yourself: ask it to solve $3x + 2 = 17$ and confirm it gives hints, not answers, until you've shown two tries.
 9. **Kit.** Combination lock and a small lockbox (Quests start in week 1). Masking tape, a tape measure, a marble or golf ball, and a board for the ramp experiment (Unit 1, week 1). A second deck of cards. The breadboard kit and multimeter aren't needed until Unit 7.
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3. Cloud setup: one link, any device (about 20 minutes, once)

Hudson's computer isn't your MacBook, so the Workbench needs to live at a web address and save progress somewhere both computers can reach. Two free pieces: a Google Sheet as the save server, and GitHub Pages as the web host. You'll only do this once; new builds are a 2-minute upload.

Part A: the save server (Google Sheet + Apps Script, 10 minutes)

1. In your Google Drive, create a new Google Sheet. Name it **Olympus Progress**.
2. Menu: **Extensions → Apps Script**. A code editor opens. Delete the few lines already there.
3. Open `cloud/Code.gs` from the build folder (any text editor), copy everything, paste it into the Apps Script editor. Click the save (disk) icon.
4. Top right: **Deploy → New deployment**. Click the gear next to "Select type" and choose **Web app**. Description: Olympus. Execute as: **Me**. Who has access: **Anyone**. Click **Deploy**.
5. Google will ask you to authorize. Click through (Advanced → Go to Olympus (unsafe) → Allow). It's your own script reading your own sheet; "unsafe" is Google's generic wording for anything not published to their store.
6. Copy the **Web app URL** (it ends in `/exec`). That's the save server.
7. In the build folder, open `content/config.js` in a text editor and paste the URL between the quotes:
`syncUrl: 'https://script.google.com/macros/s/.../exec'`. Save.

The sheet fills itself: one row per profile with XP, rank, badges, sessions done, and a JSON column with everything. It's also your progress tracker; chart column D any time.

Part B: the web address (GitHub Pages, 10 minutes)

1. Create a free account at github.com (you, not Hudson).
2. Top right + → **New repository**. Name: `project-olympus`. Public. Check "Add a README". Create.
3. In the repo: **Add file → Upload files**. Drag in everything from the build folder (`index.html`, `assets`, `content`, `badges`, `cloud`; the PDFs and Parent Guide can stay home). Commit message: `v.2026.9.10`. Click **Commit changes**.
4. **Settings → Pages**. Under "Build and deployment," Source: **Deploy from a branch**. Branch: `main`, folder `/ (root)`. Save.
5. Wait a minute, refresh the Pages settings page, and the link appears: `https://<your-username>.github.io/project-olympus/`. That's the Workbench. Bookmark it on every device; on an iPad, Share → Add to Home Screen.

Every new build: same **Upload files** step with the new folder's contents, commit message = version number. GitHub keeps every version in its history, so nothing is ever overwritten, and the link never changes.

Part C: profiles and PINs (2 minutes)

Open the link. Pick **Hudson** and choose a 4-digit PIN; pick **Dad** on your device and choose yours. From then on, on any device: open the link, pick your name, enter your PIN, and everything is there. Progress saves a moment after every action (the little cloud chip at the top says "saved"). If the internet drops mid-session, the chip says "offline," progress is kept in that browser, and it syncs the next time it can.

Two honest notes. The PINs are for keeping brothers and dads out of each other's XP, not for stopping a determined attacker; the sheet is only ever reachable by someone who has the link and a PIN. And Claude accounts are for adults, so the Claude tutor runs on your account; the Workbench login has nothing to do with Claude.

If you'd rather skip the cloud for now: leave `config.js` empty and use the local file plus the progress file (Progress page → Save / Load). Everything else works the same.

4. How a week runs, and what you do

Sessions 1 to 3 (Mon-Wed, roughly): he works through Warm-up → Story → Practice → Apply → Log. About 45 minutes. You're nearby, not hovering. He asks Claude for hints; he asks you when Claude is being useless.

Lab Day (Thursday or Friday): the experiment, the Sheets build, the Labor (end of unit), the Quest (end of unit), and Beat Dad Friday.

Your prep, once per week (15 minutes):

1. Dad mode on. Open the week's sessions and skim the Story tabs. If something's wrong or off-tone, note it; I'll fix it in the next build.
2. Check the Apply → Dad notes on each session. They tell you what to watch for and what to ask at dinner.
3. On Quest weeks (week 1 and week 4 of this build): print the clue cards, hide them, set the lock, load the box.
4. Dad mode off.

Badges only you can award (Badges page, Dad mode): Feynman (explains an idea with no notes, clearly enough you could re-explain it), Willman (performs a trick he designed and explains why it works), Bug Hunter (catches Claude in a real, provable error), Sheet Wizard (builds a working model from a blank sheet), Mat Scientist (brings real timed or filmed jujitsu data into a problem). The criteria are on the Badges page. Be stingy; they mean more.

5. Scoring, so you can answer "is that fair?"

- Every problem: 10 XP (Fermi problems 15, Labor parts 25).
- First try, no hints: full XP. Each hint: minus 20%. Each wrong try: minus 10%. Floor is 30%. Retries unlimited.
- Two wrong tries plus all hints used unlocks the worked solution (0 XP but the learning still counts).
- Session cleared (all problems correct): +20. Warm-up: +5. Apply checklist complete: +10. Log written: +5. Codex definition in his own words: +10 each. Beat Dad correct: +15.
- Labors: no hints, no solution reveal, retries allowed. Beat every part → unit badge.
- Ranks: Mortal 0, Hero 1,500, Demigod 3,500, Titan 6,000, Olympian 9,000. Units 0 and 1 together are worth roughly 2,200 XP if he clears everything, so Hero should land in the last week of Unit 1, right around the Cartographer badge.

6. Hard copies (the print folder)

File	What it is	Who it's for
Teacher's Edition - Unit 0 / Unit 1	Every session in full: story, warm-up answer, every problem with answer, hints, and solution, Apply steps, Dad notes, Labor answers, Quest setup	You
Practice Sheets - Unit 0 / Unit 1	Each session's problems with writing space, no answers. Paper-first	Hudson
Quest 1 / Quest 2 Clue Cards	Cut, hide in order	You
Badge Sheet	All badges, 2 inches each. Sticker paper or card stock	Hudson's Badge Wall

To reprint anything: Dad mode → Unit page → the print links. Any session has a "Print this session" button in Dad mode. The badges folder has each badge as an SVG for Orca-Flashforge (import SVG → extrude → paint colors by face).

7. The four weeks in this build

Week	Unit	Sessions	What you prepare
1	0: Character Creation	Welcome; Fermi's Napkin; The Three Tools; Lab Day (Labor 0, Quest 1)	Tutor profile in Claude; lockbox and Quest 1 clues; be the audience for the mind-reading trick
2	1: The Language of Change	The Machine; Pictures of Relationships; Slope Is a Rate; Lab Day (Galileo's ramp)	Ramp, ball, tape, tape measure; film 5 jiu-jitsu shots in slow-mo; Beat Dad week 1
3	1 (cont.)	$y = mx + b$; Solving for x ; Equations in the Wild; Lab Day (Tip calculator)	Be the audience for his own trick; solve his two word problems; Beat Dad week 2
4	1 (cont.)	Two Lines Meet; Substitution and Elimination; The Whole Language; Lab Day (Labor 1, Quest 2, family show)	Quest 2 clues and lock; Feynman badge session (he explains slope); Beat Dad week 3

Beat Dad week 4 is loaded and waiting for the first week of Unit 2.

8. FAQ

He wants the answer and Claude won't give it. Working as designed. Two real tries, then it walks through a parallel example. If he's stuck after that, you're the tutor: ask him to explain what he's tried.

He found a mistake in the course. Great. Tell me in the project ("Unit 1 Session 7 problem 4 says X, should be Y") and it's fixed in the next build. If the mistake is in a number the app checks, confirm his answer in Dad mode, let him type the app's expected answer so the XP is credited, and tell me so it's fixed.

He finishes a session in 20 minutes. He's post-high-school; that will happen. Send him to Apply and make it real (the ramp, the sheet, the trick). Or let him bank the time. Don't pile on more problems; the point is depth, not volume.

He's stuck on the Labor. No hints by design. He can go back to the sessions, re-read, and try again tomorrow. If it's been two days, sit with him and ask questions (not answers). The Labor should feel like a boss fight, not a wall.

He forgot his PIN. Open the Olympus Progress sheet; column B is the PIN. Change it there if you want.

The cloud chip says offline. The internet is down, or the Apps Script URL in `config.js` is wrong. Progress is safe in that browser and syncs when the connection returns. Click the chip to retry. If it's offline everywhere, re-check step A6/A7.

Something looks broken. Reload the page. Progress is saved after every action. If the profile screen shows up empty, sign in again; with cloud save on, everything comes back.

Can he do this on the iPad? Yes, with the web link. Sheets and Desmos are better on the computer. Paper is the same everywhere.

Real names and stats. The course uses real players, real 2026 World Cup speeds, and named characters on purpose. If this ever goes public, that layer gets swapped out. Nothing else changes.

Appendix A: Claude tutor profile (paste this in)

You are the math tutor for Project Olympus, an applied-math program for Hudson, who is 13, tests far above grade level, and is learning algebra, geometry, and intro calculus through real applications: soccer, Fortnite, Minecraft, Zelda, jiu-jitsu, magic tricks, money, physics, Greek mythology. His favorite scientist is Richard Feynman.

Rules you always follow:

1. Never give the final answer to a practice problem until Hudson has shown two genuine attempts. Use a hint ladder instead: first a nudge, then the method, then a similar worked example with different numbers.
2. Define every technical term in plain English the first time you use it, in one sentence.
3. When he shows work (typed or a photo of his notebook), find the exact step where it went wrong and ask a question that leads him to see it. Do not just correct it.
4. Ask him to explain his reasoning back to you. Praise precise explanations more than right answers.
5. Estimate first: before any calculation, ask what he expects the answer to be roughly, and why.
6. Be funny when it fits. Never condescending. He is sharp; talk to him like it.
7. If he asks you to just give the answer, remind him of the deal and offer a hint. If he says he is stuck after two real tries, walk through a parallel example, then let him finish his own.
8. Keep replies short. One idea at a time. No walls of text.
9. If you are not certain of a numeric result, say so and tell him to verify with a calculator or Google Sheets. He earns a badge for catching you in a mistake; if he is right, admit it plainly and cheerfully.
10. Encourage paper: diagrams, tables, written checks. Suggest he draw it when a problem has a shape or a motion in it.

Appendix B: What's in the folder

- `index.html` and `Project Olympus.html`: the Workbench (identical; `index.html` is the one GitHub Pages needs, the other is friendlier to double-click).
- `content/config.js`: where the cloud save URL goes (Section 3, step A7).
- `cloud/Code.gs`: the save server code to paste into Apps Script (Section 3, step A3).
- `assets/`: styles, engine, badge art. Don't edit.
- `content/`: the lessons (`unit0.js`, `unit1.js`, `unit1b.js`), the intro, Beat Dad problems, the tutor prompt. Plain text; you can read them.
- `badges/`: one SVG per badge for printing or slicing.
- `print/`: the PDFs listed in Section 6.
- `Parent Guide v.2026.9.10.docx` and `.pdf`: this document.

Future builds arrive as new versioned folders (`v.2026.9.16`, and so on). Nothing gets overwritten. The cloud save and the web link carry across builds; you upload the new files and the link stays the same.

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